



AI Act Navigator

Guide & template

FREE GUIDE + TEMPLATE

The AI System *Inventory.*

You cannot govern AI you have not catalogued. This guide shows you how to register every AI system your organisation builds or uses, classify its risk tier, and track compliance — and it pairs with a ready-to-fill CSV template.

The register that *everything* hangs on.

No single article of the EU AI Act says “keep an inventory.” But the moment you try to meet the duties that **are** in the Act — risk management (Art. 9), quality management (Art. 17), human-oversight assignment (Art. 26), AI literacy (Art. 4) and cooperating with authorities (Art. 21/26) — you need one place that lists every AI system, its risk tier, its owner and its status. The inventory is the practical instrument that makes all of those possible and demonstrable.

START HERE, WHATEVER YOUR SIZE

An inventory is the cheapest, highest-leverage first move in AI Act compliance. It turns “we use AI somewhere” into a concrete list you can triage by risk — and it surfaces the AI hiding inside the SaaS tools you already pay for, where you are a **deployer** with real Article 26 duties.

What a good inventory lets you do

- ☐ See every AI system at a glance — including AI features inside third-party tools.
- ☐ Classify each by risk tier, so you spend effort where the Act actually demands it.
- ☐ Assign an owner and human oversight to each high-risk system.
- ☐ Show an authority, on request, exactly what you run and how you govern it.

The thirteen *columns*.

The companion CSV has these columns. Fill one row per AI system. Keep it somewhere your whole governance group can reach.

COLUMN	WHAT TO RECORD
system_id	A unique identifier for the system in your register.
system_name	The commercial or internal name of the system.
vendor	The provider (or “internal” if you built it in-house).
role	Your role: Provider, Deployer, Both, or Other.
intended_purpose	What the system does in your context, in plain English.
risk_tier	Prohibited / High-risk / Limited / Minimal — after the classifier.
annex_iii_area	If high-risk under Annex III, which of the 8 areas applies.
owner	The person accountable for this system.
data_processed	Types of personal or sensitive data it handles.
human_oversight_assigned	Yes / No — is a trained oversight person assigned?
literacy_training_done	Yes / No — is AI literacy documented for its users?
compliance_status	Not started / In progress / Compliant / Under review.
notes	Deadlines, open gaps, links to documentation.

How to build it *in an afternoon*.

1 Sweep for AI

List everything: tools you bought, models you built, and AI features switched on inside existing software. Ask each team what they use.

2 Classify the risk tier

Run each system through the free Risk-Tier Classifier. Most will be minimal-risk — record that and move on.

3 Record role, owner and data

Are you the provider or the deployer? Who owns it? What data does it touch? These decide your obligations.

4 Triage and track

Sort by risk tier, assign owners and oversight to the high-risk ones, and set a review cadence.

PROMPT TO CLASSIFY A SYSTEM

Acting as an EU AI Act analyst, classify this AI system: **[name + what it does]**, used by **[team]**, supplied by **[vendor or “in-house”]**. Tell me the likely risk tier with a one-line justification, whether we are the provider or deployer, the Annex III area if any, and the three biggest open questions before I rely on this.

GET THE EDITABLE TEMPLATE

This guide ships with a CSV you can fill in now.

Open the **AI System Inventory Template (CSV)** that came with this download, or grab it any time at aiact-navigator.com/ai-inventory. Then run each system through the free Risk-Tier Classifier and work the Readiness Checklist. Subscribe to The AI Act Brief so you hear when the rules change.

SOURCES

EU AI Act (Regulation (EU) 2024/1689), Articles 4, 9, 17, 21, 26 and Annex III. EUR-Lex and the AI Act Explorer (artificialintelligenceact.eu). Guidance, current as of 10 June 2026 — not legal advice.



AI Act Navigator

Find your way through the *EU AI Act*.

Free tools, plain-English guides and always-updated deadlines at aiact-navigator.com